

5.7 There are physical causes and human causes of water insecurity.	a. The growing mismatch between water supply and demand has led to a global pattern of water stress (below 1,700 m³ per person) and water scarcity (below 1000 m³ per person). (7)
	b. The causes of water insecurity are physical (climate variability, salt water encroachment at coast) as well as human (over abstraction from rivers, lakes and groundwater aquifers, water contamination from agriculture, industrial water pollution).
	c. The finite water resource faces pressure from rising demand (increasing population, improving living standards, industrialisation and agriculture), which is increasingly serious in some locations and is leading to increasing risk of water insecurity. (F: projections of future water scarcity)